

Tilman Waffenschmidt

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Research Interests

Political Economy, Development Economics, Economic History, Migration

Current Position

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics

Chair of International and Development Politics, Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Axel Dreher
Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg, Germany

Sep 2023 – present

Education

University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong

Visiting Ph.D. Student; Host: Prof. Austin Strange

Sep 2025 – Nov 2025

University of Mannheim, Mannheim, Germany

Ph.D. coursework, Graduate School of Economic and Social Sciences (GESS)

2023

University of Texas at Dallas, Richardson, TX, USA

Philipps University of Marburg, Marburg, Germany

Master of Science in International Political Economy (Double Degree), GPA: 4.0/4.0

2022 – 2023

2021 – 2022

HTW Berlin, Berlin, Germany

Master of Arts in International and Development Economics, GPA: 3.3/4.0

2020 – 2021

Stellenbosch University, Stellenbosch, South Africa

Semester abroad

2019

University of Hamburg, Hamburg, Germany

Bachelor of Arts in Socioeconomics, GPA: 3.6/4.0

2016 – 2020

Work in Progress

Talk Shows, Populism, and the Far Right: Evidence from Germany's Political Talk-Show Universe, 1998–2025

The Loyalty Paradox: Ethnic Mobilization, Public Resources, and Electoral Strategy in Sub-Saharan Africa, with Cäcilia Stapper

Pressure at Home, Presence Abroad: Development Projects and Chinese Mobility to Africa with Tobias Heidland, Annika Kaiser, Linda Lochner, and Song Yuan

Ballots, Borders, and Election Cycles: How Elections Influence Migration Politics

Globalization and Discontent: How Globalization Fuels Political Polarization with Valentin Lang

Seeds of Change: Dietary Composition and Cultural Evolution in Early Human Societies with Tobias Korn

From Capitol Hill to Ancestral Homes: Diasporas and U.S. Foreign Aid with Anika Khan

The Pope: Moral Evaluation and Social Responsibility with Andreas Fuchs and Robin Möllerherm

Other Professional Experience

Student Research Assistant <i>Philipps University of Marburg, Research Group “Sustainable Use of Natural Resources”</i>	Dec 2021 – Aug 2023
Research Intern <i>German Institute for Global and Area Studies (GIGA), Germany</i>	Aug 2020 – Oct 2020
Intern <i>Friedrich-Ebert-Stiftung, Lusaka, Zambia</i>	Aug 2018 – Oct 2018
Intern <i>German Bundestag, Berlin, Germany</i>	Jun 2016
Voluntary Service <i>Hospital in Asunción, Paraguay</i>	Sep 2015 – Mar 2016

Teaching and Supervision

Supervision at Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg Research Seminar Political Economy and Development Economics <i>Bachelor and Master; Organizer in 2025; 8 seminar papers supervised</i> Bachelor’s theses (3), Master’s theses (2)	2024 – present
Teaching Assistant at Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg Introduction to Macroeconomics	2024 – present
Teaching Assistant at Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg Empirical Public Choice	2024 – 2025
Teaching Assistant at HTW Berlin Macroeconomics and Development	2021
Teaching Assistant at HTW Berlin International Economics of the 21st Century	2021

Conference and Seminar Presentations of Research

2026

International Political Economy Society (IPES) Annual Meeting
Pressure at Home, Presence Abroad

Beyond Basic Questions Workshop, Marburg
*Talk Shows, Populism, and the Far Right**
The Loyalty Paradox
Pressure at Home, Presence Abroad

German Development Economics Conference and 1st EDEG Conference, Kiel
*The Loyalty Paradox** (poster)

European Public Choice Society Annual Meeting, Madrid
*Ballots, Borders, and Election Cycles**
The Loyalty Paradox

2025

Workshop “Politics of International Development”, University of Hong Kong
*Ballots, Borders, and Election Cycles**

University of Haifa
*Ballots, Borders, and Election Cycles**

Beyond Basic Questions Workshop, Regensburg
*Ballots, Borders, and Election Cycles**

* Presented by me; unmarked presentations were given by coauthors.

Scholarships and Funding

Doctoral Scholarship, Friedrich-Ebert-Stiftung (~ 75,000 €)	2025 – 2028
Ph.D. in Political Economy, Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg	
PROMOS Scholarship, Philipps University of Marburg / DAAD (~ 1,400 €)	2022 – 2023
Study abroad, University of Texas at Dallas	
Scholarship, Stiftung der Deutschen Wirtschaft (sdw) (~ 7,000 €)	2020 – 2021
M.A. International and Development Economics, HTW Berlin	
Scholarship, Stiftung der Deutschen Wirtschaft (sdw) (~ 17,000 €)	2016 – 2020
B.A. Socioeconomics, University of Hamburg	

Summer Schools

Barcelona School of Economics	2025
Difference-in-Differences with Panel Data <i>Lecturer: Jeffrey M. Wooldridge</i>	
Centre for Economic Policy Research (CEPR)	2024
Twenty-third Summer School in International and Development Economics (Gargonza, Italy) <i>Lecturers: Claudio Ferraz & Sandra Sequeira</i>	
Nova School of Business and Economics	2024
Development Economics: Practical Issues in Designing and Analyzing Field Experiments <i>Lecturer: David McKenzie</i>	

Civic Engagement

Organization of events, d carb Future Economy Forum	2021
Deputy Chair, Jusos Hamburg-Altona	2018 – 2019
Member of the Executive Committee, Jusos Hamburg-Altona	2017 – 2019
Member of the Executive Committee, SPD Flottbek-Othmarschen	2017 – 2019
Treasurer, Amnesty International University Group	2017 – 2019
Member, Social Democratic Party of Germany (SPD)	2014 – present
Member, Amnesty International	2013 – present

Skills

Programming & Software: Stata, R, EViews, L^AT_EX, MS Office

Languages: German (native), English (fluent), French (basic), Spanish (basic)

References

Prof. Dr. Axel Dreher

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Prof. Dr. Andreas Fuchs

University of Göttingen
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Prof. Dr. Tobias Heidland

Kiel Institute for the World Economy
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